

Let a Thousand Languages Bloom!

Transifex can be your gateway to translations.

For most open source projects, translations are pretty important. Projects that are used by desktop users, such as desktop environments, GUI applications, and distributions, most frequently ship localised user interfaces, documentation, websites and other types of resources.

Take Fedora, for example -- one of the most popular Linux distributions out there. Around 60 per cent of its users use a localised desktop, and the percentages may probably be higher with other major desktop environments. In the case of Fedora content, this gets translated to something like 3-5 million users. With contributions having such a large audience

and impact, it's no surprise that the open source translation community is very active, and most major open source projects enjoy an active community devoted to translating the project into various languages.

Challenges in FOSS localisation

Typically, software developers use an internationalisation platform like *gettext*, which parses the source code and extracts the translatable strings from the code into special PO files. These files are handed to translators, who translate them into a target language using a variety of tools.

The challenge for most projects lies in receiving those translation files back in